
CLIENT DELIVERY SYSTEM

VIDEO TREATMENT

Brief, shot list, call sheet, deliverables

Owner: Claude drafts from intake. Devon approves and shoots.

Fill this in, don't invent it. Everything below comes from the intake — especially section B, where the owner's own words are written verbatim. Those words are the film.

THE REALITY THIS IS BUILT AROUND

One visit. Sixty to ninety minutes on site. No stakeout, no return trip.

A job can run all day and you are not there for all of it. The film is cut from whatever's actually happening in the window you're on site — not from a controlled before-and-after arc that requires planning the visit around the job's schedule instead of yours.

A brand story film is proof, not advertising. The customer is buying a promise about work that doesn't exist yet, from someone they met once. So: real crew, real work, real voice, no stock. That part doesn't change. What changes is how much of the job you need to witness to prove it — the answer is *some of it, well shot*, not all of it.

PART 1 — THE BRIEF [FILL FROM INTAKE]

Client:

Trade:

Shoot date:

Location(s):

On-camera person:

The offer (*confirm the exact wording with the owner before the shoot — this is a real commercial claim, not a paraphrase*):

Who's watching:

(Homeowner mid-research? Facility manager? Be specific — it changes the tone.)

The fear we're answering:

(Every trade has one — "will it last," "will they show up," "will they disappear halfway," "will it cost double what they quoted." Name theirs — the offer and the crew footage answer it.)

Their actual words (verbatim from intake B — do not clean these up):

PART 2 — STRUCTURE

Default 20–30 seconds. Four beats. This is the primary deliverable — native ad length, not a cutdown of something longer.

BEAT	SEC	WHAT HAPPENS
1. Hook	0–3	Crew mid-task, the most visually interesting thing happening when you arrive. Pattern interrupt, not a logo.
2. Owner + offer	3–12	Owner to camera: name, business, the offer stated plainly and correctly. This is the spine of the ad.
3. Problem solved	12–22	Fast-cut b-roll of the crew working — proof the offer is backed by real people doing real work.
4. Close	22–30	Owner or text card: how to claim it. Phone, site, or both.

The offer line needs to be exact. Everything else on this page is "ask questions, cut the answers" — the offer is the one exception. Confirm the wording with the owner before you roll, get it clean in one or two takes, and don't paraphrase it in the edit.

If the visit produces enough good footage, a longer cut is a bonus, not the goal — see Part 6. Don't plan the shoot around getting one; build it in the edit only if the material supports it.

PART 3 — SHOT LIST & B-ROLL

Works for any trade. **Shoot what's happening when you're there.** Nothing below requires arriving before the job starts or staying until it ends.

● = **the money shot.** If the visit is short, get these first. **VERT** = shoot **9:16 natively** on the day. Reframed 16:9 always looks reframed.

First: find this client's money shot

Every trade has one moment that's genuinely satisfying to watch and that competitors never film. Find it before the shoot with two questions to the owner:

1. "What part of the job would someone stop and watch?"

2. "What do you do that a bad crew skips?"

The answer to #1 is your hook. The answer to #2 is what the crew footage should prove.

If they can't answer, look for the moment where **the material changes state** — liquid to solid, loose to taut, rough to smooth, broken to whole. That's almost always it, and it doesn't require being there for the whole state change — a few seconds of it happening is enough.

The list — get these in the window you have

A. Owner on camera ● — the priority

- ☐ ● The offer, clean, one or two takes, confirmed wording
- ☐ Name, business, one line on what they do
- ☐ One organic credibility line from Part 4, if there's time

B. Crew working ● — most of your footage

- ☐ ● **VERT** The money shot , 4–5 takes, multiple angles
- ☐ Hands working — no face, just competence
- ☐ The tool doing its job, tight
- ☐ Material texture, macro
- ☐ ● Two people on one task — crews read as capable, soloists read as small
- ☐ **VERT** Wide of the whole operation
- ☐ Truck, tools coming off the rack, arrival if you're there for it

C. Human ●

- ☐ ● One genuine unguarded moment — someone laughing. *Beats ten posed ones*
- ☐ Crew talking something through, pointing at the work
- ☐ Logo on truck or shirt, shallow depth

D. Finished work — opportunistic only, never planned around

- ☐ If a finished job is sitting there already (yesterday's, not today's), shoot it
- ☐ If your visit happens to land on a wrap, get it — but don't schedule around this
- ☐ Detail: the edge, the joint, the seam — wherever quality shows, on whatever's finished nearby

A locked-off before/after pair is a bonus if the timing genuinely lines up — you're there right as they start, or right as they finish a short task. It is never worth waiting around for, and it is never required for the ad to work. The owner's offer and real crew footage carry the proof now.

Reference — where the money shot usually lives

Starting points only. Confirm with the owner; they know better than this table.

TRADE	LIKELY HOOK
Coatings / epoxy	Decorative flake thrown mid-air, side-lit
Screen enclosure	Spline roller running the channel

TRADE	LIKELY HOOK
Remodel	Cutting, fitting, a cabinet or fixture going in
Roofing	Tear-off, material coming away, or new material going down
Painting	First cut-in line, brush edge
Landscaping	Fresh edge cut into turf
HVAC / plumbing	Hands on the tool, the part going in
Concrete	Screed pull across wet pour
Detailing / cleaning	The half-and-half pass

When the job has no visible action to film — service calls, inspections, consultations — lean harder on the owner. The offer line and one organic credibility answer carry the whole piece; b-roll becomes hands, tools, truck, and the customer conversation if one's happening.

PART 4 — INTERVIEW QUESTIONS

For the credibility line only — never the offer, which is confirmed wording, not an ask-and-cut answer.

Ask these. Let them ramble. The usable line is almost always the third sentence of an answer, after they stop performing. You need one good line, not all eight answers.

1. Tell me what you do, like you're telling a neighbor.
2. What's the part of the job most people don't see?
3. What do customers worry about before they call you?
4. What do you do differently from the guy down the road?
5. What goes wrong on a bad job — and what do you do about it?
6. Why should someone pick you?

Q5 is the most valuable question on this list. Everyone answers 4 and 6 with a slogan. Nobody rehearses 5, so that's where the credible answer lives.

Never feed them lines — except the offer. If they say something great, ask them to say it again, don't say it for them. The offer is the one line you *do* help them land correctly.

PART 5 — CALL SHEET [SEND 48H BEFORE]

Visit length: 60–90 minutes. Not a full-day booking, not a commitment to catch the whole job.

Date / arrival time / done by:

Address:

Contact on site + mobile:

Who needs to be there: the on-camera person, and ideally the crew already mid-task when you arrive — arriving after work has started means you walk straight into b-roll instead of waiting for something to happen.

What the client must have ready:

- Confirm the offer wording before the visit, not on camera for the first time
- Site clean and presentable — the space, vehicles, uniforms
- Anyone on camera dressed the way they'd meet a customer
- Crew actually working during the window, if at all possible

What Devon brings:

- Camera, lenses, support
- Lav + shotgun audio
- Lights if the location needs them
- Backup media, batteries charged
- Release forms

Weather backup:

PART 6 — DELIVERABLES

DELIVERABLE	SPEC	WHERE IT'S USED
Offer spot — the primary deliverable	9:16, 20–30s	Meta ads, GBP, social
Cutdown / alt version	9:16, 15s	A/B test against the primary
Bumper	6s	Retargeting, pre-roll
Stills	15–20	Landing page, GBP photos
Brand story cut (<i>bonus, only if footage supports it</i>)	16:9, 60–90s	Landing page hero, YouTube — build only if the visit produced enough

Turnaround: first cut within 7 days of shoot. One revision round included.

Say this out loud when you deliver: the stills matter as much as the film. GBP photos are a ranking and conversion input, and most competitors have none.

RULES

1. **Never script the owner — except the offer.** Confirm its wording, don't improvise it on camera.
2. **One visit, 60–90 minutes.** No stakeouts, no scheduled return trips for an "after."
3. **Shoot vertical on the day.** Reframed 16:9 always looks reframed.
4. **No stock footage. Ever.** The entire point is that this is real.
5. **The offer spot is the deliverable.** A longer brand story is a bonus if the footage earns it,

never the goal you're shooting toward.